Grand Rounds · October 2026

SIGN-OUT

Question 15

Pheochromocytoma & neural crest

BLOCK	QUESTION	VIDEO
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What you need to know before moving on.

Question 15

A 34-year-old man comes to the physician because of episodes of pounding headache, palpitations, and drenching sweats over the past 4 months. The episodes last 10 to 20 minutes and occur several times weekly. His brother underwent thyroidectomy for a thyroid tumor at age 30 years.

Blood pressure is 138/88 mm Hg; during an episode in the office, it rises to 196/112 mm Hg. Plasma free metanephrines are markedly increased. CT scan of the abdomen shows a 4-cm left adrenal mass.

The cells that give rise to this patient's adrenal tumor share an embryologic origin with which of the following?

A Cells of the adrenal zona glomerulosa

B Follicular cells of the thyroid gland

C Hepatocytes

D Melanocytes of the skin

E Somatotrophs of the anterior pituitary gland

ANSWER AND VIDEO ON THE NEXT PAGE

QUESTION 15 · PHEOCHROMOCYTOMA & NEURAL CREST

Answer D.

Melanocytes of the skin

THE CLASS

25%

got it right (3 of 12)

MOST CHOSEN WRONG

B

4 of 12 · Follicular cells of the thyroid gland

Watch the explanation

Opens the video in your browser.